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Vontobel
Bleicherweg 21
Zürich

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Application for Senior AI Architect

Dear Hiring Manager,

In my current role as Software Architect at Digitec Galaxus I have spent more than a year actively engaging with the question of how agentic AI systems can be embedded responsibly and at production quality into complex, established enterprise landscapes, and this question lies at the heart of the position you are advertising. I am therefore applying with strong conviction for the role of Senior AI Architect at Vontobel.

My profile is that of a hands-on architect who has never stepped away from implementation. In my current role I am responsible for the architectural evolution of Switzerland's largest e-commerce platform while at the same time driving the adoption of AI tooling across team boundaries. In practice this means contributing to company-wide AI engineering practices as an active member of the AI Task Force and the AI Coding Guild, and organising internal workshops on AI-assisted coding and the change management that needs to accompany it. This work has given me a clear understanding of what it takes, both organisationally and technically, for AI initiatives to make the transition from promising pilots into production environments where they can carry real business weight.

I have been engaging in depth with agentic architectures, the Microsoft Agent Framework, MCP servers, and the orchestration of multiple agents within a single system, and I share what I learn on these topics through my blog at dotnetagents.net. While my current focus has been on the .NET ecosystem, the underlying patterns for RAG, tool use, evaluation, and secure LLM integration are language-agnostic, and my earlier work with Python on the modernisation of a complex legacy design system at Ansaldo Energia gives me confidence that I can become productive quickly in a Python-centric stack. The structural requirements of a regulated AI platform, namely model and prompt lifecycle management, evaluation pipelines, drift detection, reproducibility, and auditability, are at their core the same architectural principles that I have applied successfully in regulated environments at Axpo, Swiss Life, and Zühlke over the past years.

What appeals to me about Vontobel is the explicit ambition to take AI systems beyond the pilot stage into production-ready and regulatorily sound solutions, together with the family-owned and long-term oriented ownership structure that gives this ambition a degree of consistency that is genuinely rare in the financial industry. A role that is explicitly framed as hands-on architectural leadership with mentoring responsibility and close collaboration with Security, Risk, and Compliance corresponds very precisely to the kind of impact I want to have in the next stage of my career.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss in person how I can contribute to the architecture and the build-out of your AI platform.

Yours sincerely,

Roman Weis